

Philipp Hilbert. *Product architect for custody-grade infrastructure.*

Positioning, 13 years owning regulated technical platforms, from quantum-secure encryption to defence AI, now focused on crypto custody where security constraints and product clarity must coexist.

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§ WHY THE VAULT

MPC-based custody is one of the few product surfaces where a wrong requirements decision has irreversible security consequences, threshold signing, non-extractable key shares, and HSM integration are not forgiving of ambiguity. That is precisely where rigorous requirements engineering and risk-first discovery create durable value. The posting's explicit call for someone who can "translate cryptographic constraints into clear, testable product requirements" is the exact mechanic I built at Qcrypt AG, where quantum-resistant encryption concepts had to become shippable, auditable product in under two minutes of install time. *That is the kind of work where German-engineering precision and crypto-native intuition compound.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not held a formal role inside a licensed custody operator or a regulated exchange. My custody-domain knowledge is substantive, co-founding a hardware encryption company, eight years as an active DeFi and CEX user across Hyperliquid, Jupiter, and Across Protocol, and hands-on study of liquidation mechanics and market microstructure, but it comes from the builder and power-user side rather than from inside an institutional vault team. The transferable mechanic is strong: I have repeatedly turned security and cryptographic constraints into well-defined, auditable product requirements in regulated environments, and I bring the discipline to do so again here.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo requirements and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, ambient code review during backlog refinement
- **Cursor**, codebase navigation and context-grounded edits
- **Lovable**, rapid UI prototyping for discovery workshops
- **GPT**, document drafting and structured edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation and pipeline design
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-facing roadmap and narrative decks
- **Framer**, interactive prototype walkthroughs for client sign-off

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps, Docker, Jenkins, CI/CD, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin with Spring Boot, Django, Shopware, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

PHOENIX882 / LIBERATION OF BAJOR [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A personal crypto-infrastructure lab: backtesting engine, trading bots, and a multi-agent coding framework, all built alone.

- phoenix882.com is a trading-strategy backtesting platform built to test algorithmic decision frameworks against live and historical crypto market data.
- Liberation of Bajor is a file-queue-based multi-agent coding framework, designed to run agentic loops without managed orchestration infrastructure.
- Also built Hyperion, an aFRR balancing-market pipeline reconstructing marginal prices over merit-order data, illustrating the same infrastructure instinct applied to a different regulated market.
- Directly relevant: the same mindset behind non-custodial key flows, deterministic state machines, and failure-mode enumeration that custody platforms require.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT THE VAULT

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the cryptography research, security, and engineering leads; map every open backlog item to its actual driver, customer commitment, audit finding, or regulatory obligation, and surface the three places where requirements are too vague to acceptance-test.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the acceptance criteria.

Take the highest-priority MPC or HSM story and rewrite its acceptance criteria from first principles, threshold-signing assumptions, failure modes, and edge-case coverage, so engineering can build and auditors can verify.

WEEK 3+

Close the loop.

Establish a regular cadence with compliance, security, and customer-facing teams so roadmap trade-offs are grounded in real audit posture and commercial commitments rather than internal momentum alone.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at The Vault,

I am applying for the Product Owner role on your MPC-based custody platform. The combination you are looking for, someone who can hold a credible conversation with cryptographers and security engineers, then translate that conversation into unambiguous, auditable product requirements, is the job I have been doing in adjacent regulated environments for over a decade. I want to do it where the stakes are highest: at the infrastructure layer of digital asset custody.

The clearest evidence I can offer is Qcrypt AG, the hardware-software security company I co-founded and owned as Product Owner from 2016 to 2021. The core product challenge was identical in structure to what The Vault faces: enterprise buyers would not accept complexity or opacity, but the underlying cryptography, one-time pads, true-random-number generators, quantum-resistant key management, imposed hard constraints that could not be wished away.

My job was to make those constraints legible as product requirements, write acceptance criteria that held up under external audit, and ship something that installed in under two minutes without sacrificing any of the security guarantees. That is the same translation task your job description names explicitly.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, another environment where security posture, multinational regulatory obligations, and engineering capacity competed for the same roadmap slot. I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD that reduced rollout time from days to 30 minutes and made the platform hotfix-capable, a concrete example of using delivery infrastructure as a product lever rather than a delivery detail. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I served as Deputy IT Security Officer while simultaneously managing a platform migration and UI relaunch, which gave me direct experience of how audit obligations and commercial goals share a backlog and sometimes conflict. At EMIL Group I took a Claims Center from concept to production with no prior precedent, compressing time-to-market for a new insurance product from many months to under a week, the kind of zero-to-one technical product delivery that a growing custody platform will need repeatedly.

Beyond my professional roles, I am a genuine long-term participant in the crypto ecosystem: eight-plus years of active use across Hyperliquid, Jupiter, Bitget, Across Protocol, and 1inch, study of liquidation mechanics, MEV, and market microstructure, and a personal infrastructure lab that includes a crypto backtesting engine, trading bots, and a multi-agent coding framework I built alone. I am not a custody-platform insider yet, and I have said so honestly in my application. But I know the product surface from the user and builder side, and the requirements engineering, security governance, and stakeholder alignment work is something I have done for regulated, technically deep products throughout my career.

The Vault's posting describes a role that sits at the centre of everything, between cryptography research, engineering, compliance, and external partners, and holds that centre through clear written specifications and sound prioritisation. That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and owner with 13 years of end-to-end ownership on regulated, technically deep platforms, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance infrastructure, healthcare, and

fintech. I have co-founded a quantum-secure encryption company as Product Owner, served as Deputy IT Security Officer on a national data platform, and consistently turned security and cryptographic constraints into auditable, shippable product requirements. I work credibly with cryptographers, security engineers, and compliance teams, and I write specifications that hold up under external audit.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Security and encryption product ownership: quantum-resistant OTP/true-RNG, Deputy IT Security Officer, audit-ready requirements, attack-vector mitigation.

Requirements and specification: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, UAT.

Product management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP and PoC definition, A/B testing, user research, product lifecycle management.

Agile and scaled delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning.

Stakeholder and leadership: C-level and executive reporting, cross-functional team leadership, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Technical environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Data and analytics: ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis.

AI products and tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, EU AI Act, Explainable AI.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI & DATA PLATFORM 2024 TO 2025

Owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme. Introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD: rollout time fell from days to 30 minutes. Redirected product from a UI-led workflow to a developer-code-first design after instrumentation showed zero user adoption of the original.

**BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR
ANALYTICS 2023 TO 2024**

National labour-market analytics platform. Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt, migrated bare-metal to containers, led full UI relaunch. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to its top 10%; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM/KIS interface personally: digital anamnesis time fell from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition dropped from near-total to one departure. Shipped Claims Center zero-to-one, compressing time-to-market from months to under one week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL & PAYMENTS 2021 TO 2022

POS and forecourt systems. Moved research into production across a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

**BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · SECURE GOVERNMENT
DATA 2021**

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B 2019 TO 2020

Migrated legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · ENERGY INFRASTRUCTURE 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

**WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017 TO 2018**

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING 2025 TO 2026

Two-sided B2B marketplace, zero to one alone. Anonymity-until-payment model; WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface; LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016 TO 2021

Hardware-software product for enterprise quantum-resistant encryption. Shipped a three-layer install in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018 TO 2021

Fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013 TO 2018

Mobile group-based P2P payment product built from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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